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Inventor(s)	Ochi; Takao et al.

Encryption key generation

Abstract

A first device transmits a first random number to a second device through a first quantum channel, and receives a second random number from the second device through a second quantum channel. The first device generates a first encryption key based on the first random number and the second random number. The second device transmits the second random number to the first device through the second quantum channel, and receives the first random number from the first device through the first quantum channel. The second device generates a second encryption key based on the first random number and the second random number.

Inventors: Ochi; Takao (Tokyo, JP), Yoshino; Ken-ichiro (Tokyo, JP), Tajima; Akio (Tokyo, JP)

Applicant: NEC Corporation (Tokyo, JP)

Family ID: 55399110

Assignee: NEC CORPORATION (Tokyo, JP)

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Primary Examiner: Ho; Duc C

Background/Summary

REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) The present application is a Continuation application of Ser. No. 16/924,535 filed on Jul. 9, 2020, which is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 15/502,245 filed on Feb. 7, 2017, which has issued as U.S. Pat. No. 10,735,328 on Aug. 4, 2020, and which is a National Stage Entry of PCT/JP2015/004158 filed on Aug. 20, 2015, which claims priority from Japanese Patent Application 2014-170087 filed on Aug. 25, 2014, the contents of all of which are incorporated herein by reference, in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present invention relates to an information communication system, an information communication method and device to transmit and receive information between communication devices.

BACKGROUND ART

(2) In a data transmission between communication devices, not all of information transmitted from a transmission side is received at a receiving end. For example, it is known that a packet loss occurs due to a load state or the like of a network, and, in addition, there is a communication system in which only a part of transmitted data reaches to the receiver as characteristics of a transmission system including a transmitter, a receiver, and a channel that connects them. As an example of such communication system, a quantum key distribution (QKD) system will be described briefly.

(3) It is necessary to share a shared key required for encryption and decryption of information between a transmission end and a receiving end as secret information, and QKD technology is regarded to be promising as a technology to generate and share such secret information. According to the QKD technology, contrary to a conventional optical communication, it is possible to generate and share a common key between a transmitter and a receiver by transmitting a random number with the number of photons per bit equal to one or less. The QKD technology has the security that is based on the principle of quantum mechanics that a photon observed once cannot be completely

returned to the quantum state before the observation, not the security that is based on conventional computational complexity.

(4) It is necessary in the QKD technology to carry out several steps before an encryption key used for cryptographic communication is generated. Hereinafter, a generation process of a typical encryption key will be described with reference to FIG. 1.

(5) As shown in FIG. 1, in a single photon transmission, a random number is transmitted through a quantum channel by a weak optical pulse train with the number of photons per bit equal to one or less, as mentioned above. As the QKD method, a BB84 method using four quantum states is widely known (Non Patent Literature 1), for example. When a transmitter transmits an original random number by a single photon transmission, most of it is lost due to the loss or the like of a transmission line; and bits that can be received by a receiver become a very small part of the transmitted bits, which is called a raw key. For example, the data volume that can be received by a receiver is about 1/1000 of the transmitted data volume.

(6) Subsequently, a basis reconciliation, error correction, and privacy amplification processing are performed on the raw key that is received with most of the transmitted random numbers having been lost due to the quantum channel transmission, using a communication channel with normal optical intensity (classical channel). In each step of the basis reconciliation, error correction and, privacy amplification processing, a bit elimination is carried out to eliminate bits disclosed to the other side and the possibility of wiretapping. Thus, in a transmission system in which most of transmitting data is lost in a transmission channel, and data elimination is performed in subsequent processes, a received data volume finally obtained becomes very small compared with the transmitted data volume.

CITATION LIST

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SUMMARY OF INVENTION

Technical Problem

(8) As mentioned above, in a transmission system in which most of transmitting data is lost, a problem newly arises that the processing efficiency declines because large unbalance occurs with respect to a data volume to be processed between a transmission end to process transmitting data and a receiving end to process received data, and because the processing load of the transmitting end becomes larger.

(9) The object of the present invention is to provide an information communication system, an information communication method and device that can achieve the dispersion of a processing load between communication devices that perform information transmission.

Solution to Problem

(10) An information communication system according to an exemplary aspect of the present invention, an information communication system to transmit and receive information between communication devices, includes a first transmission system configured to transmit information in a direction from a first communication device to a second communication device; and a second transmission system configured to transmit information in a direction opposite to the direction of the first transmission system, wherein part of transmission information is received as received information in each of the first transmission system and the second transmission system.

(11) A communication device according to an exemplary aspect of the present invention, a communication device to transmit and receive information to and from another communication device, includes a transmitting means for transmitting information to the another communication device through a first transmission line; and a receiving means for receiving information through a second transmission line from the another communication device, wherein part of transmission

information is received as received information in each of the first transmission line and the second transmission line.

(12) An information communication method according to an exemplary aspect of the present invention, an information communication method to transmit and receive information between the communication devices, includes transmitting and receiving information at each of a first communication device and a second communication device by use of a first transmission system and a second transmission system, the first transmission system and the second transmission system having transmission directions opposite to each other; and receiving part of transmission information as received information in each of the first transmission system and the second transmission system.

Advantageous Effects of Invention

(13) According to the present invention, it becomes possible to disperse a processing load between communication devices.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram to illustrate information-processing steps in a quantum key distribution (QKD) system.

(2) FIG. 2 is a block diagram illustrating a schematic configuration of an information communication system in accordance with a first example embodiment of the present invention.

(3) FIG. 3 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration example of an information communication system in accordance with a second example embodiment of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 4 is a block diagram illustrating a configuration example of an information communication system in accordance with a third example embodiment of the present invention.

EXAMPLE EMBODIMENT

The Outline of Example Embodiments

(5) According to the example embodiments of the present invention, when part of transmission information is received as received information in a transmission system set between communication devices, it becomes possible to disperse a processing load between the communication devices by providing a pair of transmission systems with the transmission directions opposite to each other. In each communication device, if a predetermined processing using transmission information and a predetermined processing using receiving information are performed, the equalization of the processing loads can be achieved between the communication devices, and sufficient information generation efficiency can be obtained. Because both of the transmitter and the receiver are provided in each communication device, transmit data can be received by a receiver in the own device, and it becomes possible to adjust parameters of a transmitter in each communication device. Example embodiments of the present invention will be described below in detail using figures. The direction of the arrow in the figures indicates a direction as an example and does not limit the direction of the signals between the blocks.

1. The First Example Embodiment

(6) As illustrated in FIG. 2, in an information communication system according to the first example embodiment of the present invention, a first communication device **10** and a second communication device **20** perform information transmission in the directions opposite to each other by a first transmission system **31** and a second transmission system **32**. The first transmission system **31** performs one direction transmission from the first communication device **10** to the second communication device **20**, and includes a transmitter **101** of the first communication device **10**, a receiver **201** of the second communication device **20**, and a first transmission line **33** connecting the transmitter **101** and the receiver **201**. The second transmission system **32** performs

one direction transmission in the direction opposite to that of the first transmission system **31**, and includes a receiver **102** of the first communication device **10**, a transmitter **202** of the second communication device **20**, and a second transmission line **34** connecting the transmitter **202** and the receiver **102**.

(7) The first communication device **10** includes the transmitter **101**, the receiver **102** and a data processor **103**. The data processor **103** receives inputs of transmission information TD1 on the transmitter **101** and received information RD2 from the second communication device **20** that is received by the receiver **102**, and performs predetermined data processing on the information respectively. The second communication device **20** includes the receiver **201**, the transmitter **202** and, a data processor **203**. The data processor **203** receives inputs of transmission information TD2 on the transmitter **202** and received information RD1 from the first communication device **10** that is received by the receiver **201**, and performs predetermined data processing on the information respectively. The data processor **103** of the first communication device **10** and the data processor **203** of the second communication device **20** can perform an identical information processing and generate a similar sort of information, for example.

(8) The first transmission system **31** transmits the information in the direction from the first communication device **10** to the second communication device **20**, and has the characteristics that a received information volume becomes less than a transmission information volume. That is to say, the transmission information TD1 transmitted from the transmitter **101** is partially lost in the first transmission line **33** and/or the receiver **201**, and only part of the transmission information TD is received by the receiver **201** as the received information RD1.

(9) The second transmission system **32** transmits the information in the direction from the second communication device **20** to the first communication device **10** contrary to the first transmission system **31**, and has the characteristics that a received information volume becomes less than a transmission information volume, as is the case with the first transmission system **31**. That is to say, the transmission information TD2 transmitted from the transmitter **202** is transmitted through the second transmission line **34** and is received by the receiver **102**. On this occasion, the transmission information TD2 is partially lost in the second transmission line **34** and/or the receiver **102**, and only part of the transmission information TD2 is received by the receiver **102** as the received information RD2.

(10) Consequently, the data processor **103** receives inputs of the transmission information TD1 having a large data volume and the received information RD2 having a relatively small data volume and performs processing, and similarly, the data processor **203** receives inputs of the transmission information TD2 having a large data volume and the received information RD1 having a relatively small data volume and performs processing. If the first transmission system **31** and **32** have similar transmission characteristics, and the data processors **103** and **203** perform identical information processing, it becomes possible to reduce the unbalance of loads regarding the data processing between the first communication device **10** and the second communication device **20**.

(11) As mentioned above, according to the present example embodiment, it becomes possible to disperse the processing loads between the communication devices by setting a pair of transmission systems **31** and **32** each of which transmits in a direction opposite to each other. That is to say, the processing capacity can be utilized efficiently because the processing load can be equalized between the communication devices. It becomes possible to generate efficiently desired information because each communication device can generate the information by processing both of the transmission information and the received information.

2. The Second Example Embodiment

(12) As illustrated in FIG. 3, an information communication system according to the second example embodiment of the present invention is a system in which the first example embodiment mentioned above is applied to a QKD system.

(13) In FIG. 3, a communication device A and a communication device B transmit a single photon pulse train modulated by random number information in the directions opposite to each other using a quantum channel transmission system Q1 and a quantum channel transmission system Q2. The quantum channel transmission system Q1 includes a transmitter 301 of the communication device A, a receiver 401 of the communication device B, a transmission line (quantum channel) connecting the transmitter 301 and the receiver 401. The quantum channel transmission system Q2 includes a transmitter 402 of the communication device B, a receiver 302 of the communication device A, and a transmission line (quantum channel) connecting the transmitter 402 and the receiver 302. In the present example embodiment, respective transmission lines of the quantum channel transmission systems Q1 and Q2 may be composed of optical fibers that physically differ from each other or may be wavelength-multiplexed in an identical optical fiber.

(14) The communication device A and the communication device B perform optical communication with the optical power having a normal level using a classical channel transmission system C. The classical channel transmission system C includes an optical communication unit 304 of the communication device A, an optical communication unit 404 of the communication device B, and a transmission line (classical channel) connecting the optical communication unit 304 and the optical communication unit 404. The communication device A and the communication device B perform, in addition to the synchronous processing, the basis reconciliation with the other communication device, the error correction, and the privacy amplification processing, as mentioned above, using the classical channel transmission system C. A classical channel in the classical channel transmission system C may be provided by wavelength multiplexing in the same optical fiber as that including the quantum channel transmission systems Q1 and Q2. Alternatively, a synchronization channel for the synchronous processing can be provided in another optical fiber.

(15) The classical channel of the classical channel transmission system C may be an electric communication path by an electric signal, not an optical communication. In this case, it is only necessary to replace the optical communication units 304 and 404 with communication units that transmit and receive an electric signal.

(16) The communication device A includes the transmitter 301, the receiver 302, an encryption key generation unit 303, the optical communication unit 304, and a control unit 305. The encryption key generation unit 303 corresponds to the data processor 103 in the first example embodiment. The encryption key generation unit 303 receives inputs of transmission information (original random number) TD1 on the transmitter 301 and received information RD2 received by the receiver 302 from the communication device B. Then, the encryption key generation unit 303 generates an encryption key by performing the basis reconciliation with the communication device B through the optical communication unit 304, the error correction, and the privacy amplification processing, as mentioned above. The control unit 305 controls the overall operations of the communication device A.

(17) The basic configuration of the communication device B is similar to that of the communication device A. That is to say, the communication device B includes the receiver 401, the transmitter 402, an encryption key generation unit 403, the optical communication unit 404, and a control unit 405. The encryption key generation unit 403 corresponds to the data processor 203 in the first example embodiment. The encryption key generation unit 403 receives inputs of transmission information (original random number) TD2 on the transmitter 402 and received information RD1 received by the receiver 401 from the communication device A. Then, the encryption key generation unit 403 generates an encryption key by performing the basis reconciliation with the communication device A through the optical communication unit 404, the error correction, and the privacy amplification processing, as mentioned above. The control unit 405 controls the overall operations of the communication device B.

(18) In the quantum channel transmission system Q1, the transmitter 301 of the communication device A puts the transmission information (original random number bit information) TD1 on a

very weak optical pulse train with the number of photons per bit equal to one or less, and transmits it to the receiver **401** of the communication device B through a quantum channel. The weak optical pulse train in transmission is lost in the middle of the transmission line, and only part of it reaches the receiver **401**. The receiver **401** outputs detected data to the encryption key generation unit **403** as received information RD1. As mentioned above, the information volume of the received information RD1 gets down to about 1/1000 of the information volume of the transmission information TD1, for example.

(19) In the quantum channel transmission system Q2, the transmitter **402** of the communication device B puts the transmission information (original random number bit information) TD2 on a very weak optical pulse train with the number of photons per bit equal to one or less, and transmits it to the receiver **302** of the communication device A through a quantum channel. In this case, its transmission direction is opposite to that of the quantum channel transmission system Q1. The weak optical pulse train in transmission is lost in the middle of the transmission line, and only part of it reaches the receiver **302**. The receiver **302** outputs detected data to the encryption key generation unit **303** as received information RD2. It is assumed that the information volume of the received information RD2 also gets down to the same level (about 1/1000) of the information volume of the transmission information TD2 as is the case with the quantum channel transmission system Q1.

(20) The encryption key generation unit **303** receives inputs of the transmission information TD1 having a large data volume and the received information RD2 having a quite small data volume. The encryption key generation unit **303** can generate a first encryption key by performing the basis reconciliation, the error correction, and the privacy amplification processing, on the transmission information TD1 and the received information RD1 in the other communication device B through the classical channel transmission system C. Similarly, the encryption key generation unit **403** also receives inputs of the transmission information TD2 having a large data volume and the received information RD1 having a quite small data volume. The encryption key generation unit **403** can generate a second encryption key by performing the basis reconciliation, the error correction, and the privacy amplification processing, on the transmission information TD2 and the received information RD2 in the other communication device A through the classical channel transmission system C. Because information volume attenuation arises equally in each of a pair of quantum channel transmission systems Q1 and Q2 having transmission directions opposite to each other, the same level of information volume is processed; consequently, the equalization of processing loads can be achieved between the encryption key generation units **303** and **403**.

3. The Third Example Embodiment

(21) An information communication system according to the third example embodiment of the present invention is a system obtained by adding a self-diagnostic function to each communication device according to the above-mentioned second example embodiment. Specifically, a transmission parameter adjusting function, and an optical route switching function of changing the route of transmission light so as to input the transmission light into the receiver in the own device at a time of parameter adjustment mode, are added.

(22) Generally, in order to adjust a parameter such as transmission optical intensity of a transmitter that transmits the above-mentioned weak optical pulse, a receiver to receive the weak optical pulse is required. Since weak light is very weak light with one photon or less per bit, a detector that can detect a single photon is required; consequently, an avalanche photodiode is usually used. Accordingly, the parameter adjustment is performed using a receiver in the other communication device.

(23) However, there is likely to be a wire-tapper on the transmission path, and there is the threat of damaging the security of QKD if a wire-tapper intervenes during the parameter adjustment. In addition, since a single photon detector is very expensive, it is not rational to install the receiver only for the parameter adjustment.

(24) According to the present example embodiment, each communication device has a transmitter and a receiver for a quantum channel because a pair of quantum channel transmission systems Q1 and Q2 for transmission in opposite direction is provided. Accordingly, it is possible to utilize this receiver as a single photon receiver for parameter adjustment. The present example embodiment will be described below with reference to FIG. 4. In FIG. 4, the encryption key generation unit and the optical communication unit are not illustrated that are included in the communication device according to the above-mentioned second example embodiment.

(25) As illustrated in FIG. 4, the communication device A according to the present example embodiment includes an optical switch 311 in the output side of the transmitter 301 and an optical switch 312 in the receiving side of the receiver 302, respectively. In addition, the communication device A includes a parameter adjustment unit 313 that adjusts a parameter such as the transmission optical intensity of the transmitter 301 using the detected data by the receiver 302. The control unit 305 controls the switching operations of the optical switches 311 and 312 and the adjustment operations of the parameter adjustment unit 313. Similarly, the communication device B according to the present example embodiment includes an optical switch 412 in the output side of the transmitter 402, and an optical switch 411 in the receiving side of the receiver 401, respectively. In addition, the communication device B includes a parameter adjustment unit 413 that adjusts a parameter such as the transmission optical intensity of the transmitter 402 using the detected data by the receiver 401. The control unit 405 controls the switching operations of the optical switches 411 and 412 and the adjustment operations of the parameter adjustment unit 413.

(26) The optical switch 311 in the communication device A includes an input port Pi, an output ports Po1 and Po2, and the optical switch 312 includes input ports Pi1, Pi2 and an output port Po. The input port Pi of the optical switch 311 is optically connected to the output of the transmitter 301, the output port Po1 is optically connected to the above-mentioned quantum channel transmission system Q1, and the output port Po2 is optically connected to the input port Pi2 of the optical switch 312, respectively. The output port Po of the optical switch 312 is optically connected to the input of the receiver 302, the input port Pi1 is optically connected to the above-mentioned quantum channel transmission system Q2, and the input port Pi2 is optically connected to the output port Po2 of the optical switch 311, respectively.

(27) In a normal operation state, the control unit 305 sets the optical switch 311 and the optical switch 312 so that the input port Pi and the output port Po1 of the optical switch 311 may be connected, and the input port Pi1 and the output port Po of the optical switch 312 may be connected. Consequently, the operation for the encryption key generation is performed through the quantum channel transmission systems Q1 and Q2, as mentioned above.

(28) At the time of parameter adjustment, the control unit 305 sets the optical switch 311 and the optical switch 312 so that the input port Pi and the output port Po2 of the optical switch 311 may be connected, and the input port Pi2 and the output port Po of the optical switch 312 may be connected. Consequently, the weak optical signal outputted from the transmitter 301 is inputted into the receiver 302 through the output port Po2 of the optical switch 311, and the input port Pi2 and the output port Po of the optical switch 312. This enables the parameter adjustment unit 313 to adjust a parameter such as the transmission optical intensity of the transmitter 301 using the detected data by the receiver 302. In the communication device B, the optical switches 411 and 412, are configured and operate as with the above; accordingly, the description of them is omitted.

(29) As mentioned above, according to the present example embodiment, an optical switch is included in each communication device as optical route switching means for turning back the transmission light from the transmitter to the receiver in the own device. At the time of the parameter adjustment mode, the control unit can complete the parameter adjustment in the own device by switching the optical switches so that the transmission light may be inputted into the receiver in the own device; therefore, it is possible to perform the parameter adjustment of the transmitter without damaging the security of QKD.

(30) In the first to third example embodiments mentioned above, a pair of transmission system having transmission directions opposite to each other has been illustrated, but the present invention is not limited to these example embodiments, and a communication system having a plurality of pairs of transmission systems may be used.

(31) The present invention has been described using the above-mentioned example embodiments as exemplary examples. However, the present invention is not limited to the above-mentioned example embodiments. That is to say, in the present invention, various aspects that a person skilled in the art can understand can be applied within the scope of the present invention.

(32) This application is based upon and claims the benefit of priority from Japanese patent application No. 2014-170087 filed on Aug. 25, 2014, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein in its entirety by reference.

INDUSTRIAL APPLICABILITY

(33) The present invention is generally applicable in an information communication system in which information transmission is performed by a plurality of transmission systems each of which has a predetermined transmission direction.

REFERENCE SIGNS LIST

(34) **10** First communication device **20** Second communication device **31** First transmission system **32** Second transmission system **33** First transmission line **34** Second transmission line **101** Transmitter **102** Receiver **103** Data processor **201** Receiver **202** Transmitter **203** Data processor **301** Transmitter **302** Receiver **303** Encryption key generation unit **304** Optical communication unit **305** Control unit **311, 312** Optical switch **313** Parameter adjustment unit **401** Receiver **402** Transmitter **403** Encryption key generation unit **404** Optical communication unit **405** Control unit **41, 412** Optical switch **413** Parameter adjustment unit

Claims

1. A device, comprising: a transmitter configured to transmit first information to another device through a first quantum channel; a receiver configured to receive second information from the another device through a second quantum channel; and a data processor configured to generate an encryption key based on the first information and the second information.
2. The device according to claim 1, further comprising: a communication unit configured to communicate with the another device and to perform at least one of synchronization, bases reconciliation with the another device, error correction and privacy amplification.
3. The device according to claim 1, wherein the first information is a number.
4. The device according to claim 1, wherein the second information is a number.
5. A system comprising: a first device configured to: transmit first information to a second device through a first quantum channel, receive second information from the second device through a second quantum channel, and generate a first encryption key based on the first information and the second information; and the second device configured to: transmit the second information to the first device through the second quantum channel, receive the first information from the first device through the first quantum channel, and generate a second encryption key based on the first information and the second information.
6. The system according to claim 5, wherein the first device is further configured to communicate with the second device and to perform at least one of synchronization, bases reconciliation with the second device, error correction and privacy amplification, and the second device is further configured to communicate with the first device and to perform at least one of synchronization, bases reconciliation with the first device, error correction and privacy amplification.
7. The device according to claim 5, wherein the first information is a number.
8. The device according to claim 5, wherein the second information is a number.
9. A method comprising: transmitting first information to another device through a first quantum

- channel, receiving second information from the another device through a second quantum channel; and generating an encryption key based on the first information and the second information.
10. The method according to claim 9, further comprising: communicating with the another device, and performing at least one of synchronization, bases reconciliation with the another device, error correction and privacy amplification.
11. The device according to claim 9, wherein the first information is a number.
12. The device according to claim 9, wherein the second information is a number.
13. A method comprising: in a first device, transmitting first information to a second device through a first quantum channel, receiving second information from the second device through a second quantum channel; and generating a first encryption key based on the first information and the second information; and in the second device, transmitting the second information to the first device through the second quantum channel, receiving the first information from the first device through the first quantum channel, and generating a second encryption key based on the first information and the second information.
14. The method according to claim 13, further comprising: in the first device, communicating with the second device, and performing at least one of synchronization, bases reconciliation with the second device, error correction and privacy amplification; and in the second device, communicating with the first device, and performing at least one of synchronization, bases reconciliation with the first device, error correction and privacy amplification.
15. The device according to claim 13, wherein the first information is a number.
16. The device according to claim 13, wherein the second information is a number.
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